

Scheme 3

Stage 3 Full-Text Deep Coding Scheme

Full-text adjudication and interpretive coding for the musculoskeletal and neuropathic reviews

DRAFT FOR EXPERT EVALUATION. These coding schemes are a working draft circulated for expert evaluation. They have not been applied to a final review corpus. The current manuscript is a test run that exercised an earlier, coarser generation of these schemes in the Python workflow with an LLM (gemini-2.5-flash); the full end-to-end run is deliberately held until after expert feedback, and the refinements proposed here are awaiting sign-off before any re-run.

At a Glance

Workflow position

Full-text coding after Stage 3 candidate identification and retrieval triage.

Operational mode

Human-coded template with pilot and reliability subsamples. AI may assist concept mapping; final adjudication is human.

Unit of analysis

One retrieved full-text review, coded against the complete text.

Provenance basis

The generated full-text template and the prose Stage 3 codebook.

Research questions

RQ2 (scope, balance, integration); RQ3 (concepts, frameworks, definitions); SQ1 (conceptual problems)

Tagline

One uniform instrument applied to both pain-condition tracks; human-coded with pilot and reliability subsamples

Canonical Source Paths

- `src/protocol/codebooks/stage3_codebook.md`
- `src/review_stages/04_extraction/codebooks/stage3_codebook.csv`
- `src/bps_review/extraction/stage3_prep.py`
- `src/review_stages/04_extraction/forms/stage3_fulltext_coding_template.csv`
- `src/review_stages/04_extraction/forms/stage3_pilot_sample.csv`
- `src/review_stages/04_extraction/forms/stage3_reliability_sample.csv`

Purpose

This scheme is the full-text deep coding framework for Stage 3 candidate reviews. It is applied as one uniform instrument to both planned reviews: the musculoskeletal chronic pain review and the

neuropathic chronic pain review. The pain-condition family is the varying input that decides which records each review reads; the coding fields, value vocabularies, and anchors are identical across both tracks so the two reviews stay directly comparable.

It captures conceptual depth that cannot be resolved reliably at the abstract level: coverage of each BPS domain, pairwise and triadic integration quality, biopsychosocial typology, psychological concepts, theoretical frameworks, conceptual problems, and evidential quotations.

Stage 3 is where the review's central claim is tested: does a BPS-labelled review actually integrate the three domains, and if so, how.

Domain Coverage Fields

Coverage is coded at the level of substantive treatment, not keyword presence. The same four-level ladder applies to each domain.

domain_coverage_bio

Depth of biological content.

- **elaborated** The domain is developed as a substantive analytic thread. Several distinct constructs or mechanisms are discussed, weighed, or synthesized rather than merely named. *Choose when:* A dedicated section or sustained multi-paragraph treatment; Two or more distinct constructs named and related to one another; Evidence is appraised, not only cited in passing. *Not this if:* A single passing sentence; Only the domain umbrella word. *Boundary:* Prefer elaborated over mentioned when the domain carries its own argument rather than appearing as one item in a list.
- **mentioned** The domain is explicitly present with at least one named construct, but it is not developed into a sustained analytic thread. *Choose when:* One or two named constructs; A short paragraph or scattered sentences. *Not this if:* Only the umbrella word such as the bare token psychosocial. *Boundary:* Prefer mentioned over minimal when a concrete construct is named rather than only the domain umbrella term.
- **minimal** The domain appears only as an umbrella label or a single incidental reference, with no concrete construct attached. *Choose when:* Bare token such as social factors with no elaboration; One incidental clause. *Not this if:* Any named construct, which would qualify as mentioned. *Boundary:* Prefer minimal over absent when the domain word appears at all.
- **absent** The domain is not represented in the substantive content of the review, even if a global BPS label is used elsewhere. *Choose when:* No domain-specific language beyond a global BPS label. *Not this if:* Any named construct or umbrella mention. *Boundary:* A review can carry a BPS label and still score a domain as absent. The label alone is never counted as coverage.

domain_coverage_psych

Depth of psychological content.

- **elaborated** The domain is developed as a substantive analytic thread. Several distinct constructs or mechanisms are discussed, weighed, or synthesized rather than merely named. *Choose when:* A dedicated section or sustained multi-paragraph treatment; Two or more distinct constructs named and related to one another; Evidence is appraised, not only cited in passing. *Not this if:* A single passing sentence; Only the domain umbrella word. *Boundary:* Prefer elaborated over mentioned when the domain carries its own argument rather than appearing as one item in a list.
- **mentioned** The domain is explicitly present with at least one named construct, but it is not developed into a sustained analytic thread. *Choose when:* One or two named constructs; A short paragraph or scattered sentences. *Not this if:* Only the umbrella word such as the bare token psychosocial.

Boundary: Prefer mentioned over minimal when a concrete construct is named rather than only the domain umbrella term.

- **minimal** The domain appears only as an umbrella label or a single incidental reference, with no concrete construct attached. *Choose when:* Bare token such as social factors with no elaboration; One incidental clause. *Not this if:* Any named construct, which would qualify as mentioned. *Boundary:* Prefer minimal over absent when the domain word appears at all.
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domain_coverage_social

Depth of social content.

- **elaborated** The domain is developed as a substantive analytic thread. Several distinct constructs or mechanisms are discussed, weighed, or synthesized rather than merely named. *Choose when:* A dedicated section or sustained multi-paragraph treatment; Two or more distinct constructs named and related to one another; Evidence is appraised, not only cited in passing. *Not this if:* A single passing sentence; Only the domain umbrella word. *Boundary:* Prefer elaborated over mentioned when the domain carries its own argument rather than appearing as one item in a list.
- **mentioned** The domain is explicitly present with at least one named construct, but it is not developed into a sustained analytic thread. *Choose when:* One or two named constructs; A short paragraph or scattered sentences. *Not this if:* Only the umbrella word such as the bare token psychosocial. *Boundary:* Prefer mentioned over minimal when a concrete construct is named rather than only the domain umbrella term.
- **minimal** The domain appears only as an umbrella label or a single incidental reference, with no concrete construct attached. *Choose when:* Bare token such as social factors with no elaboration; One incidental clause. *Not this if:* Any named construct, which would qualify as mentioned. *Boundary:* Prefer minimal over absent when the domain word appears at all.
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Integration Fields (the core RQ2 contribution)

Integration is the scheme's highest-resolution construct. The pairwise ladder distinguishes a stated mechanism from a mere direction, an association, or a bare co-mention.

integration_bio_psych

Biological to psychological integration.

- **mechanistic** The review specifies a pathway or mechanism by which one domain acts on the other (a how, not only a that). *Choose when:* Named mediator, moderator, or physiological or behavioural pathway; Language such as via, through, drives, sensitizes, amplifies. *Not this if:* Two domains listed as co-occurring with no linking process. *Boundary:* Mechanistic requires a stated process; if only a direction of effect is claimed without a pathway, use directional.
- **directional** A directional or causal influence between the two domains is asserted, but no mechanism is given. *Choose when:* X predicts, increases, or worsens Y; A stated arrow of influence.

Not this if: A pathway is described, which would be mechanistic; Mere co-mention with no direction. *Boundary:* Directional requires an arrow of effect; if the link is only an association or correlation, use descriptive.

- **descriptive** The two domains are linked as associated or correlated, without direction or mechanism. *Choose when:* Associated with, related to, correlated with, linked to. *Not this if:* A stated direction of effect, which would be directional. *Boundary:* Descriptive requires an explicit relational claim; a bare co-occurrence in the same sentence is only mentioned.
- **mentioned** Both domains appear near one another but the relationship is not characterized at all. *Choose when:* Two domains named in the same passage with no relational verb. *Not this if:* Any associational, directional, or mechanistic claim. *Boundary:* Prefer mentioned over none only when both domains are present in a shared context rather than in separate isolated sections.
- **none** No relationship between the two domains is articulated anywhere in the review. *Choose when:* Domains handled in separate silos, or one domain absent. *Not this if:* Any co-located relational statement. *Boundary:* If either domain is absent, the pairwise code defaults to none.

integration_psych_social

Psychological to social integration.

- **mechanistic** The review specifies a pathway or mechanism by which one domain acts on the other (a how, not only a that). *Choose when:* Named mediator, moderator, or physiological or behavioural pathway; Language such as via, through, drives, sensitizes, amplifies. *Not this if:* Two domains listed as co-occurring with no linking process. *Boundary:* Mechanistic requires a stated process; if only a direction of effect is claimed without a pathway, use directional.
- **directional** A directional or causal influence between the two domains is asserted, but no mechanism is given. *Choose when:* X predicts, increases, or worsens Y; A stated arrow of influence. *Not this if:* A pathway is described, which would be mechanistic; Mere co-mention with no direction. *Boundary:* Directional requires an arrow of effect; if the link is only an association or correlation, use descriptive.
- **descriptive** The two domains are linked as associated or correlated, without direction or mechanism. *Choose when:* Associated with, related to, correlated with, linked to. *Not this if:* A stated direction of effect, which would be directional. *Boundary:* Descriptive requires an explicit relational claim; a bare co-occurrence in the same sentence is only mentioned.
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integration_bio_social

Biological to social integration.

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- **directional** A directional or causal influence between the two domains is asserted, but no mechanism is given. *Choose when:* X predicts, increases, or worsens Y; A stated arrow of influence. *Not this if:* A pathway is described, which would be mechanistic; Mere co-mention with no direction. *Boundary:* Directional requires an arrow of effect; if the link is only an association or correlation, use descriptive.
- **descriptive** The two domains are linked as associated or correlated, without direction or mechanism. *Choose when:* Associated with, related to, correlated with, linked to. *Not this if:* A stated direction of effect, which would be directional. *Boundary:* Descriptive requires an explicit relational claim; a bare co-occurrence in the same sentence is only mentioned.
- **mentioned** Both domains appear near one another but the relationship is not characterized at all. *Choose when:* Two domains named in the same passage with no relational verb. *Not this if:* Any associational, directional, or mechanistic claim. *Boundary:* Prefer mentioned over none only when both domains are present in a shared context rather than in separate isolated sections.
- **none** No relationship between the two domains is articulated anywhere in the review. *Choose when:* Domains handled in separate silos, or one domain absent. *Not this if:* Any co-located relational statement. *Boundary:* If either domain is absent, the pairwise code defaults to none.

integration_triadic

Three-domain integration.

- **mechanistic** A genuinely three-domain mechanism is proposed in which biological, psychological, and social factors act on one another as a system. *Choose when:* A cross-domain loop or cascade involving all three domains; All three domains appear as active parts of one explanation. *Not this if:* Two domains interact while the third is only listed. *Boundary:* Reserve for reasoning where removing any one domain breaks the proposed explanation.
- **descriptive** All three domains are related to the outcome in an integrated narrative, but as a joint description rather than a specified mechanism. *Choose when:* A coherent three-domain account without a stated pathway. *Not this if:* A concrete cross-domain pathway, which would be mechanistic. *Boundary:* Descriptive triadic still requires all three domains to be in genuine relation, not merely co-present.
- **partial** Two domains are integrated with each other while the third is present but only loosely attached. *Choose when:* A strong bio-psych link with social mentioned but not integrated. *Not this if:* All three integrated (descriptive or mechanistic); Only one domain present. *Boundary:* Partial marks a dyadic integration inside a nominally triadic frame.
- **none** No three-domain integration is present; domains stand in parallel or one or more is absent. *Choose when:* Serial mention of separate domains; Single-domain reasoning. *Not this if:* Any genuine multi-domain relational claim. *Boundary:* Serial listing of B, P, and S in turn is none, not descriptive.

integration_mechanism_summary

Concise free-text summary of the proposed cross-domain pathways. (*free text*)

Typology and Balance

The summary judgments that answer RQ1 at full-text depth.

overall_balance

Relative emphasis across domains.

- **balanced** No domain dominates; the three are weighted comparably.

- **psych-dominant** Psychological content dominates.
- **bio-dominant** Biological content dominates.
- **social-dominant** Social content dominates.
- **dyadic** Two domains dominate and one is marginal.
- **unclear** Balance cannot be determined.

bps_typology

Full-text BPS operationalization type.

- **true_integrative** Explicit cross-domain causal or mechanistic interaction is central to the review's logic. *Boundary:* Requires at least descriptive triadic integration plus two elaborated domains.
- **multifactorial** Multiple domains covered meaningfully but mostly in parallel. *Boundary:* Distinguished from true_integrative by the absence of a genuine cross-domain link.
- **pseudo_bps** BPS language used but one or more core domains are thin, absent, or tokenistic.
- **rhetoical_bps** BPS used mainly as framing or justification without analytic substance.
- **narrow_despite_label** BPS claimed but substantive scope is essentially single-domain.
- **unclear** Type cannot be determined.

Psychological Concepts and Evidence

Concept-level fields that feed RQ3 and the concept map.

concept_definitions_present

Whether the review defines the psychological constructs it uses.

- **yes** Constructs are explicitly defined or operationalized.
- **partial** Some constructs defined, others named only.
- **no** Constructs named without definition.

psychological_concepts_fulltext

Normalized, semicolon-delimited full-text concept list. *(free text)*

theoretical_frameworks_fulltext

Normalized, semicolon-delimited framework list. *(free text)*

conceptual_problems_fulltext

Conceptual issues such as vague definitions, construct overlap, tokenistic BPS use, missing social analysis, missing biology, mechanistic absence, or unclear boundaries. *(free text)*

integration_quotes_or_evidence

Supporting quotations, section references, or evidential anchors from the full text. *(free text)*

coder_id / coder_notes / adjudication_status

Provenance and adjudication tracking fields.

Proposed Refinement: Concept-Level Grid and Evidence Rule

PROPOSED REFINEMENT

Awaiting expert evaluation. Not yet applied to the pipeline.

Refinement proposed for expert evaluation. The current scheme stores concepts as a flat delimited string, which loses the structure that RQ3 needs. We propose a per-concept grid with one row per concept carrying: canonical concept name, verbatim label used in the review, definitional status (formally defined, operationalized only, named only), parent psychological subdomain (aligned to Scheme 6), associated framework, and a relation type to other concepts (is-a, part-of, or associative).

We also propose an evidence rule: any pairwise or triadic integration coded above mentioned must carry at least one verbatim quote with a section locator in `integration_quotes_or_evidence`. This makes the integration ladder auditable and prevents inflation of mechanistic codes.

Together these raise both the resolution of the concept map and the evidential quality of the integration judgments.

Worked Examples (real corpus records)

Candidate records from the manifest with the target full-text reading.

Biopsychosocial approach to tendinopathy

Narrative review, 2022, PMC cached

Coding: `bps_typology = true_integrative (target); integration_triadic = descriptive; concept_definitions_present = partial`.

Why: An integrative-signal abstract; at full text the coder tests whether the three domains are related or merely co-present. Fear-avoidance and self-efficacy are named, so concepts are at least partial.

Effects of Multidisciplinary Biopsychosocial Rehabilitation on Short-Term Pain and Disability in Chronic Low Back Pain

Network meta-analysis, PMC cached

Coding: `bps_typology = multifactorial (target); integration_triadic = none or partial; domain_coverage_bio = minimal to mentioned`.

Why: The abstract flags missing_biology and parallel-listing. Full text usually confirms a treatment-bundle framing rather than an integrated mechanism.

Reliability Architecture

How Stage 3 agreement is estimated (OSF: 20 percent, capped at 20 full texts; test run reliability subset was 18).

- Pilot sample: up to 5 records generated by `stage3_prep.py`.
- Reliability sample: about 20 percent of candidates, capped in the form-generation logic.
- Reliability fields carry independent reviewer ratings for domain coverage, triadic integration, and BPS typology, followed by adjudicated values.

Documented Divergences

- The prose Stage 3 codebook exposes the intermediary integration values partial and mentioned more explicitly than the CSV codebook. This dossier follows the prose codebook plus the actual form field names because that is the richer operational specification.
- The CSV codebook uses shorter names such as `bio_coverage`; the generated template uses `domain_coverage_bio`. The template naming is canonical here because it is the working form.

Primary Outputs Using This Scheme

- `src/review_stages/04_extraction/forms/stage3_fulltext_coding_template.csv`
- `src/review_stages/04_extraction/forms/stage3_pilot_sample.csv`
- `src/review_stages/04_extraction/forms/stage3_reliability_sample.csv`
- `src/review_stages/04_extraction/outputs/stage3_candidate_manifest.csv`